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EBU5608 Product Development and Management

Revision

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Agenda

- Exam Structure
- Type of Questions
- Topics for Revision
- Tips for Revision
- Tips for Exam Day
- Common Mistakes
- Exam Practice Exercise

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Exam Structure and Type of Questions

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Exam Structure

- You have to answer **ALL COMPULSORY 3** questions
  - Q1: (30 marks)
  - Q2: (30 marks)
- Some questions will may ask you for **examples** or to use **diagrams** where they help your explanation.
  - Q3: Article-based questions (40 marks)

    An article will be given to you a few days before the exam, so that you will have sufficient time to read and think.

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Exam Structure

The exam questions may have structure such as below:

- Q1: (30 marks)
  - Part A:
  - Part B:
- Q2: (30 marks)
  - Part A:
  - Part B:
- Q3: Scenario-based questions (40 marks)
  - Part A:
  - Part B:

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Exam Structure

- There are **not** complex **calculations** or **multiple choice** questions
- **70%** of overall mark

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Exam Questions Verbs

- **Define**: Clearly explain what a particular term means and give an example, if appropriate, to show what you mean
- **Explain**: Set out in detail the meaning of something, with reasons. Start by introducing the topic give the 'How' or 'Why'
- **Describe**: Give a clear description that includes all the relevant features – think of it as 'paintings a picture with words'
- **Discuss**: Examine, analyse carefully, and present considerations pro and con regarding the problems, or items involved; give a complete and detailed answer.
- **Compare/Contrast**: Identify the main factors that apply in two or more situations and explain the similarities and differences or advantages and disadvantages.

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How to analyse an article

- Read the article in depth to begin to **absorb the facts** and start **thinking of approaches/solutions** to the set questions.
- Carefully **consider** any **tables/charts** in the article, as authors usually don't add them unless there is a reason, often these numbers are telling a story that is **important to the situation** and **your evaluation** of it.
- At this point you should begin to **outline** what the **key findings** or **issues** are.
- **Interpret**, **evaluate**, **draw out implications** or **link together related issues**.
- If it is required, use **appropriate techniques** to further analyse the related issues.

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Topics Covered

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Topics week by week

Teaching Week 1

- Topic 1 - Introduction Product Development
- Topic 2 - Digital Transformation and Digital Products
- Topic 3 - Business Environment and Economic Environment
- Topic 4 - Innovation
- Topic 5 - Opportunity Identification

Teaching Week 2

- Topic 6 – Product Planning
- Topic 7 – Identify Customer Needs
- Topic 8 - Concept Development
- Topic 9 - System Level Design
- Topic 10 - Detail Design and Prototypes

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Topics week by week

Teaching Week 3

- Topic 11 - Design for Manufacturing
- Topic 12 - Production Ramp-up and Robust Design
- Topic 13 - Managing Intellectual Property
- Topic 14 - Introduction to Management
- Topic 15 - Managing Product Development Projects

Teaching Week 4

- Topic 16 - Quality Management and Continuous Improvement
- Topic 17 - Marketing Strategy for New Products
- Topic 18 - Start-ups and Entrepreneurship
- Topic 19 - Cybersecurity and Managing Risks

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Exam Skills and Common Mistakes

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Tips for Revision

- Begin revision early, **not at the last minute**
- Revise **lecture notes** (see latest versions to QM+)
- For further reading: core textbook, other textbooks
- **In-Class exercises** and **Tutorial exercises** can give you good **examples** to use to illustrate your answers
- Understand the **layout of the exam paper**
- Practice using **past exam papers** (see on QM+) and **invent your own questions**
- **Discuss** past exam papers and **answers with friends**

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Tips for Revision

- **Time yourselves answering questions** without looking at your notes. How long do 3 questions take to answer – allow enough time for all questions
- If you still don't understand something, **put a question** on the **"Student Forum"** on QM+

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Tips for Exam Day

- Check that you have the **right exam paper**.
- Fill out **personal details** as required – give the correct **QMUL ID Number** and **BUPT ID Number**.
- Read **ALL instructions** slowly, at least twice.
- Take time at the beginning to **read the questions carefully**, at least twice. Always check all pages.
- **Highlight key words**, notice **how many parts** there are to the question.
- **Read questions through again** very slowly to make sure you have not misunderstood any key word. **Divide your time equally among questions**.
- Give **full answers** based on the instructions.

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Common mistakes

These are examples taken from the way students answered earlier exam papers

- Some students **did not read the question correctly** and gave a different answer – occasionally for a different topic! If you do this, your answer will not be awarded any marks

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Common mistakes

- Where **examples** or **diagrams** were specifically asked for and they were not given as part of the student's answer.
  - If a question asks for examples or diagrams, this means that a number of the marks have been allocated for examples or diagrams.
  - **If you do not give examples** or **diagrams, you will not get those marks.**
- Some of the examples that were given were **completely irrelevant** - so marks were not awarded for them

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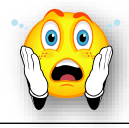
Common mistakes



- **Some students wrote very little**
  - For example, if a question asked to "**Explain**", "**Describe**" or "**Discuss**" a topic, then we would expect to see between 1-2 pages as an answer.
  - Some answer books a) only had ¼ or ½ of a page written for each question, or b) just copy/paste the slides 'content.
  - It is impossible to receive significant marks, and certainly not full marks, when so little is written.
  - **Practice** writing the amount you need for each question.

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Common mistakes

- Student ran out of time. You can avoid this by
  - **Planning** your time in the exam
  - **Practicing** answering exam questions in advance
- Answers included the use of **'etc.' or 'and so on'**
  - It is not possible for the examiners to know what the student is trying to say here – it is vital that the **full answer**, even in list form, is given

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For questions

- Any questions about the topics, exam please post on QMPlus **"EBU5608 Student Forum"**
  - **Questions posted in the last 24 hours before the exam, will be ignored**
  - **Do NOT email your lecturer – direct emails to lecturers will be ignored**
  - **Do NOT send WeChat messages to your lecturer – they will be ignored**

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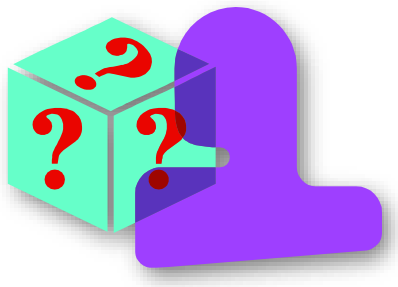
Questions?



Go to www.menti.com to post your questions

Mentimeter

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Exam Practice

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A warning!

- These slides contain sample exam questions

Don't assume that,
if it's *not* in today's slides,
it *won't* be in the exam!

Don't assume that,
if it *is* in today's slides,
it *will* be in the exam!

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Exam practice exercise

- This is **not** the exactly same format as the final exam.
- You can look at your notes, article, textbooks in this practice
  - In the real exam, you can **not** look at any notes, laptops or textbooks!
- This is not a group task, **each student should work individual**, without assistance from others.
- Do **not talk** to anybody during this practice exam
  - If you talk, you will be told to **leave** the room.

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15 minutes

Exam practice (exam paper 2024)

- This question is based on the article - ***Digital Product Development Process: Factors, Benefits and Priorities***. You will find a copy to QMPlus.

- A digital product refers to a product or service that is primarily based on digital technology, existing in a non-physical or intangible form. Digital product designers work in a delicate space that straddles the line between programmer and artist, embracing aspects of both realms.

a) Explain FIVE (5) examples of digital products.

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25 minutes

Exam practice (exam paper 2024)

b) You are a manager for a digital product project. Propose a plan with 6 (six) main tasks for the development of the new digital solution. Explain in detail each task.

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10 minutes

Evaluation

- Scan the QR code to complete:
  - Workshop evaluation form and
  - Self-reflection on your learning

You will need to provide your QMUL ID Number to complete this form.

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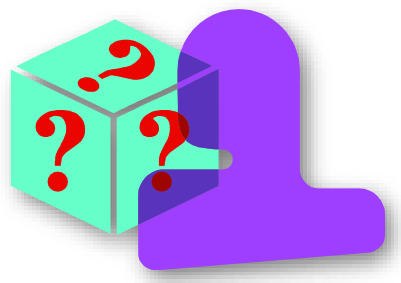
Questions?



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